

had directly launched as competitors in the smart phone market. We use this analogy, because trying to make the next global Facebook is just as silly. However, making the first Hindi-Facebook for Indians would not be, perhaps.

THE GREAT WALL

If there's one thing the Chinese do well, it's mass produce. Chinese products are flooding the globe, and at throwaway prices. Yes the Indian market has its challenges, and skilled labour to manufacture hardware has been missing over the past decade, but that's rapidly changing, and each year more and more educated and skilled Indians are passing out from college, hoping for gainful employment. Perhaps the big idea would be to start replicating the Chinese model here in India. We do have the advantage of language here, and have more English speaking people than China.

Enough with the suppositions though, it's time to get down to the ideas we've been wanting to share with you. These are based of extensive research that we did of what works and what doesn't in foreign countries, and then debated upon internally about whether they would work in India.

SOPIMA

This is a Finnish company offering a one-stop solution for managing contracts. Contracts and India go together. Be it flyovers, retail spaces in cities, or infrastructure projects in rural areas, there is a gap that needs to be filled in here. We need a solution that would not only ensure transparency, but also reduce the paperwork. The challenge, however, would be the opposition by the influential machinery and lobbyists in our country. Nevertheless, there is hope as in the wake of the 2G saga, the government and even the judiciary in our country is now pushing for 'cleaner' processes. If our authorities had an option such as Sopima in our country, probably the Supreme Court would have made it mandatory to have transparent processes for awarding and monitoring progress on all government contracts. That's the foremost area where we find a lacuna. So we suggest you step in and give us a solution.



FONYOU

This Spanish business is similar to Google Voice. Essentially, fonYou follows a mobile virtual network operator (MNVO) business model. This means, although fonYou doesn't have spectrum allocation or any infrastructure in place, all it does is provides telecom service by accessing other telecom operators. Given the widespread corruption and the sensitivity of the telecommunications industry in India today, such a move would receive support from the industry. For now, Virgin Mobile is the only virtual operator to follow this model. Virgin uses Tata Teleservices' infrastructure to provide services. What makes virtual operators unique is the bouquet of value added services (VAS). fonYou, for example, lets you call and message other phone numbers and makes all of this possible without using a SIM card. Again, another opportunity for the Indian market.



NUITEQ

Tablets, touch and gestures are all over the place. No wonder the Government of India felt a \$35-tablet was the answer to India's student community. User interfaces are increasingly leaning towards touch and is evident in the rapid growth of touch-enabled smartphones, tablets and also touch-enabled computers. Given the perfect ecosystem, a software driven service would be the perfect business idea. Railway ticketing solutions, traffic status queries and even self help kiosks in hospitals, banks or educational aids involving touch would find rapid adoption.

TRADE IN 60 SECONDS

The next innovative idea we spotted is one that lets any user set up an online store in 60 seconds. New York-based tinypay.me doesn't require you to have any account. All you need to do is mention the product you want to sell, your asking price. You want also share any proceeds of your sale with charity.

MOBILE ADVERTISING

Japan is probably the world's most tech-savvy nation. It enjoys technological advancements of the highest degree. Way back in 2006, mobile broadcasting was launched with an encouraging 25 million subscribers. The average revenue per user (ARPU) is a quantity that is used to understand the business prospects of a telecom market. This is the money a telecom subscriber spends on service. In India, the ARPU stands at Rs. 144 compared to approximately Rs. 2600 (4800 JPN) in Japan. Considering the fact that India has the second highest number of mobile phone connections in the world while Japan stands at number 7, ventures in the mobile space have a high probability of succeeding.

WIMAX UBIQUITY

We all wish we had access to networking. This time we're not talking about Facebook, but interconnectivity. We wish we had wireless hotspots in every nook and corner. Although concepts such as ubiquitous networking has been doing the rounds for quite sometime, there hasn't been any concrete development. India's dragging itself to 3G. LTE and 4G seems a distant dream. Consider countries such as Finland and Norway where citizens enjoy broadband speeds as a constitutional right. The fastest and easiest way our needs could be satiated would be a pan-India 'ubiquitous' wireless broadband network. Instead of a dongle that you insert into your laptop, wouldn't you appreciate a service where you could roam by using the strongest signal you receive, irrespective of the service provider? There needs to be an alliance between the GSM concept of handover and roaming partnerships, and the robustness and efficiency of a WiMAX backbone.



ONLINE EDUCATION

India is a rapidly growing market. People have begun considering career options other than the engineer and medical doctor stereotype. Consid-